

tion, test requirement documents and test executives.

In addition, the ATEasy IDE provides a way to write, run and debug applications in very short cycles as required by instrument-based applications. The object-oriented environment makes editing of common tasks or objects displayed in the IDE very similar to other object-oriented environments. The similar functionality greatly reduces the learning curve for ATEasy.

With ATEasy, multiple users can edit the same file representing a driver system or a program. Files contain version information that allows users to keep track of, and document, the changes. In addition, all ATEasy documents can be saved to a text format allowing comparison and merger of changes between multiple users and tracking of changes using version control software in a better way.

Workspace, applications and modules

ATEasy applications are developed in the IDE within a workspace file. Workspace file contains the programming environment and the last saved layout of the IDE. It is not a part of the application.

ATEasy applications are Windows executable files created from project files containing one or more modules. Typically, a project file contains a system, one or more programs, and one or more drivers. The system, program and driver are called ATEasy modules. Each module contains sub-modules such as forms, commands and procedures, and is stored in a project file, which may be inserted or moved between projects so that it can be reused by other ATEasy applications.

Fig. 2 shows a workspace, its project file, program, system and driver modules. The workspace file and its image in the IDE contains a list of files or documents and the state of IDE windows and their content. The IDE can load only one workspace at a time. Typically, the workspace file contains a list of one or more project files loaded by the IDE.

Hardware and Software Requirements

ATEasy is a 32-bit Microsoft Windows application program designed and tested for Windows operating systems. You must have Windows installed on your computer prior to installing ATEasy.

To install ATEasy you need the following minimum configuration:

1. A 32- or 64-bit Windows system compatible with Windows 7, VISTA, XP, Windows Server 2003/2008, Windows ME, Windows 2000 and Microsoft Windows 98
2. Internet Explorer 6.0 or higher version
3. 43.2cm (17-inch) or larger monitor. At least 1024x768 resolution is recommended for ATEasy application development.
4. TCP/IP or IPX/SPX network protocols and Windows2000 or newer version for ATEasy licence server

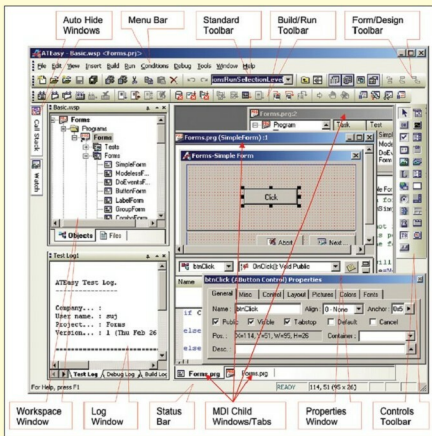


Fig. 3: Main window of the IDE with callouts to individual windows

Installing ATEasy

Insert the EFY DVD in the DVD-ROM drive. The Setup program runs automatically if your drive is set up to auto play. If Setup does not run automatically, select 'Run' from 'Start' menu and when prompted, type:

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[drive letter]:\AExplorer
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where [drive letter] is the letter assigned to your CD-ROM drive. For example, type "D:\AExplorer" if letter 'D' is assigned to your CD-ROM.

A window showing several op-

tions will be displayed. Select 'ATEasy Software' and then 'Install ATEasy' to start ATEasy setup program. A Welcome screen is displayed. Click 'Next' to continue. The next screen shows the licence agreement. When you finish reading it, click 'Yes' to continue (answering 'No' exits the Setup program). Enter your name and company name, and click 'Next' to continue.

Enter the folder where ATEasy should be installed. Click 'Browse' to